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Don't call it a comeback: VC-backed IPOs are stabilizing, not soaring

By [Michael Bodley](#)

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Halfway through 2025, US IPOs are stabilizing, but a full-fledged liquidity [recovery is still out of sight](#), according to the [Q2 2025 PitchBook-NVCA Venture Monitor](#).

Venture-backed IPO hopefuls paused their listing plans at the beginning of the quarter when new tariff policies [unsettled the markets](#). Still, a number of high-profile candidates,

such as [Circle](#) and [Chime](#), eventually pulled the trigger and [raised significant sums from investors](#).

Mature startups [already in the IPO pipeline](#) are still cautiously waiting for the right time, while secondary deals in [unicorns](#) continue to boom. In the meantime, founders are closely watching the Trump administration’s next policy moves, according to Emily Zheng, a senior VC analyst at PitchBook.

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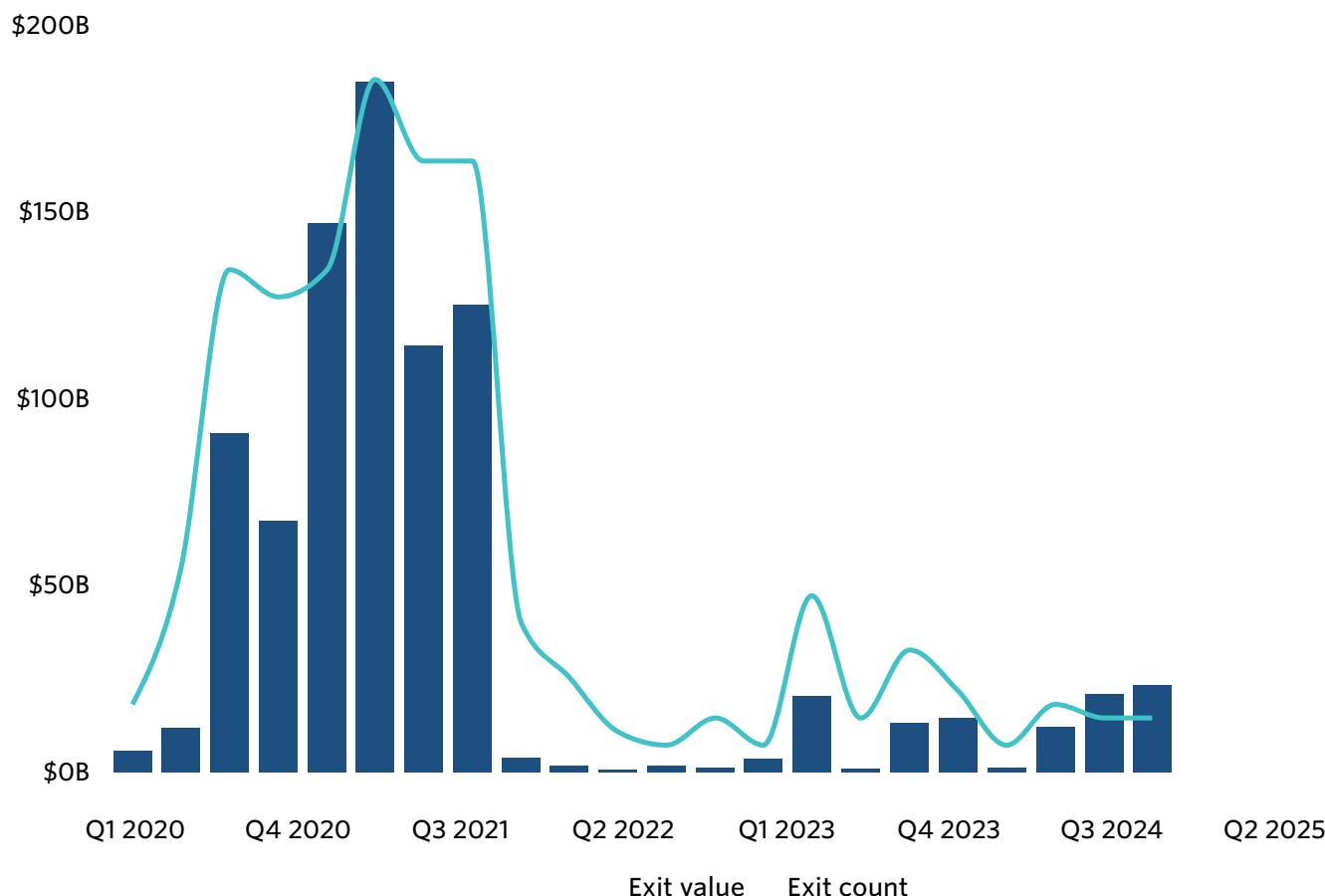
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“Even though there was a recent rise in IPOs, this doesn’t necessarily mean that this momentum will continue throughout the rest of the year,” Zheng said. “There hasn’t been a rush toward new filings yet. A lot of companies are still waiting for some key policy questions to be answered—especially regarding tariffs.”

IPOs are resetting, not ripping

VC IPO activity by quarter



Source: [Q2 2025 PitchBook-NVCA Venture Monitor](#) • Geography: US • As of June 30, 2025

Unicorns that went public in the first half of 2025 pushed cumulative exit values higher: IPOs in the second quarter totaled about \$23.2 billion, compared to \$20.9 billion in the first quarter and \$12.1 billion in Q4 2024.

Down-rounds IPOs have continued to proliferate and are [becoming more common](#), according to Zheng.

“It might sound counterintuitive, but actually, this is good news, because as down rounds become more normalized, hopefully more companies are willing to go public—and there will be more public appetite for these companies that are going public at a lower valuation,” she said.

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About [Michael Bodley](#)

Michael Bodley is a senior venture capital reporter at PitchBook News, covering top fund managers and developments affecting limited partners. Based in New York, Michael previously led TheStreet.com's crypto coverage. He also reported for Hedge Fund Alert after breaking into journalism at the San Francisco Chronicle. Originally from Baltimore, Michael graduated from Elon University.

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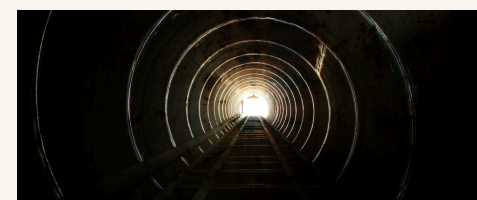
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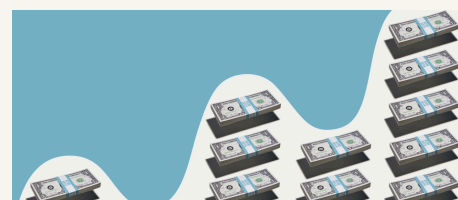


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